Chapter 2: Understanding Qualitative Research

Class 3

Significance of qualitative methods

Offers in-depth understanding of human behaviors, perspectives and experiences

Allows knowledge generation beyond structured numerical frameworks, and insight into social phenomenon

Major methods: Grounded theory, Ethnography, Phenomenology, Case study, Narrative Research

Grounded theory

Originally developed by Glaser and Strauss in the 1960s

Why did they see the need for this method?

- Need for qualitative research to have more independence and break free from pre-existing theoretical frameworks
- Need for qualitative research to have more rigour
- Need for a more inductive approach (emergence of theories from data instead of the other way around)
- Rejection of hypothesis first approach
- Emphasis on knowledge and theory generation instead of just testing

Develops theory about phenomena

Theory needs to be grounded or rooted in observation

Grounded theory

Complex iterative process

The research begins with the raising of generative questions (not rigid, not confined)

As data collection is ongoing, core theoretical concept(s) are identified

Tentative linkages are developed between the theoretical core concepts and the data via analysis

Open, flexible, rooted in nature

Grounded theory: Major analytical strategies

Coding

- process for both categorizing qualitative data and for describing the implications and details of these categories.
- First one does open coding, considering the data in minute detail while developing some initial categories.
- Second one moves to more selective coding where one systematically codes with respect to a core concept.

Table 1: Key Benefits of AI Implementation at Hospitality Industry Organisations

Theme	Advantages	Quotation
Customer communication	1. Passive tracking of consumer reactions. 2. Optimise response options and make them more prompt.	1. "Many companies already implement social listening to quickly learn about any criticisms or appraisals on social media". 2. "The inability to respond to the consumers addressing your organisation in the public domain within several hours may already be recognised as ignoring them or having poor customer service quality".
Customer servicing	Instantly identify loyal consumers returning with new orders.	"It may seem like a small thing but imagine making a second booking at the same hotel you stayed at with your family last year and receiving a reply, "John, thank you for choosing us again" or a Christmas greeting wishing all the best to your wife and two children".
Data processing	Track all consumer operations longitudinally.	"Additionally, you may track the whole consumer journey rather than just the moment of the purchase to analyse your marketing effectiveness".
Performance monitoring	Reliable productivity tracking.	"This also allows them to track their productivity and really know when they are performing well".
Services personalisation	1. Better consumer experience. 2. Upselling.	1. "This personalisation is highly convenient for making every consumer feel valued". 2. "At the individual level, personalisation supports upselling. If the system recognises the 'business-type reservation' on the basis of customer data, a live customer support specialist may offer additional services such as office space, a business lounge for work or photocopying and translation".
Predictive analytics	Capability to optimise dynamic pricing and room management.	"This is especially important for hotels that need to use dynamic pricing and have to close some rooms for refurbishment or basic repairs".

Grounded theory: Major analytical strategies

Memoing

- A process for recording the thoughts and ideas of the researcher as they evolve throughout the study
- Extensive marginal notes and comments
- Memos tend to be very open while later on they tend to increasingly focus in on the core concept.

Integrative diagrams and sessions

- The diagrams can be any form of graphic that is useful at that point in theory development
- Integrative work is best done in group sessions where different members of the research team are able to interact and share ideas to increase insight.